

This is a simple, one-page tool that identifies individual training and coaching needs compared to a profile that is common to all account managers. It identifies the knowledge, attitudes, skills and habits needed before results are expected from the account manager, not afterwards.

The green boxes represent “where the account manager needs to be”. Some boxes will go up, some will go down, some will be added and some will be deleted depending upon the strategic direction of your business.

It therefore acts as a very powerful communication tool as it explains what account managers have to be better at, do more of, less of etc.

In some cases, the green boxes may be different for account managers – if there are different KASH requirements for the key accounts.

For example, if an account manager is only working with customers in the chemicals industry then knowledge of this sector would be much higher than for colleagues working in other market sectors.

The red boxes represent where the account manager feels he or she is at the moment.

They are not an assessment by the account manager’s boss – use of the KASH Profile is essentially a self-evaluation exercise.

“Gaps” are not weaknesses – they are, by definition, an open admission of the real situation and a request for help.

Using the example, it is clear that the account manager (Bob) feels that he has 6-7 major areas of personal development. His manager should now work closely with him to address these needs and “close the gaps”.

Remember that Bob also knows how he learns best. A good manager won’t tell Bob he is going on a course to equip him with group presentation skills – the manager would ask Bob for his ideas on how to close the gap down.

If Bob’s solution is to accompany his colleague Claire on two of her presentations during the next three months (rather than sit in a classroom) then this is the solution that will probably work.....for Bob.

The KASH Profile is simple and effective.

In the best cases, it is motivational due to its high levels of participation and ownership.

In the worst cases, when an account manager leaves your company, the green boxes become the recruitment profile for the replacement and will help to shape the content of the advertisement. You win, either way.

Key:

Where the team member needs to be.

Where you feel the team member is today.

Knowledge										
Customer's Strategies and Plans	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Products / Services	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Competitors	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Own Structure, Processes Policies	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Current and Likely Legislation	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Business Planning	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Customer Profile	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Attitudes										
Team Player	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Genuinely Customer Focused	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Well Rounded Outlook	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Positive - Sees Solutions	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Goal Orientation	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Being a Catalyst for Change	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Competitive Instinct	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Strong and Resilient	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Skills										
Research and Planning	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Questioning	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Listening and Summarising	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Presenting Tailored Solutions	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Written Proposals and Letters	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Negotiating	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Internal Marketing / Persuasion	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Organising and Running Customer Meetings	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Networking Skills	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Closing / Gaining Commitment	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Habits										
Punctuality	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Well-Organised	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Appearance	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Ability to Make Things Happen	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10